ENGLISH B2 · ANSWER KEY

Past perfect continuous

Solutions and feedback for the Past perfect continuous in English B2 exercise workbook.

THIS DOCUMENT

Answer key

Model answers and concise grammar explanations for every stage in the separate exercise workbook.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Correct one stage at a time. Explain the rule aloud before marking an answer as secure.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

Duration before past is the best match because an ongoing activity measured up to a past event.

A2

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.

Past evidence is the best match because an earlier activity inferred from a past result.

A3

I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.

Interrupted process is the best match because an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision.

A4

an ongoing activity measured up to a past event

The Duration before past pattern communicates an ongoing activity measured up to a past event.

A5

an earlier activity inferred from a past result

The Past evidence pattern communicates an earlier activity inferred from a past result.

A6

an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision

The Interrupted process pattern communicates an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Duration before past / an ongoing activity measured up to a past event

The structure belongs to the Duration before past pattern. Its communicative purpose is an ongoing activity measured up to a past event.

B2

Past evidence / an earlier activity inferred from a past result

The structure belongs to the Past evidence pattern. Its communicative purpose is an earlier activity inferred from a past result.

B3

Interrupted process / an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision

The structure belongs to the Interrupted process pattern. Its communicative purpose is an extended earlier process interrupted by a later decision.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

Duration before past: had been + -ing + for/since.

C2

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.

Past evidence: had been + -ing.

C3

I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.

Interrupted process: had been + -ing + when.

C4

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

Duration before past: had been + -ing + for/since.

C5

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.

Past evidence: had been + -ing.

C6

I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.

Interrupted process: had been + -ing + when.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

had been testing

Duration before past requires “had been testing” in this model. had been + -ing + for/since.

D2

had been decorating

Past evidence requires “had been decorating” in this model. had been + -ing.

D3

had been preparing

Interrupted process requires “had been preparing” in this model. had been + -ing + when.

D4

had been + -ing + for/since

Duration before past is built as had been + -ing + for/since.

D5

had been + -ing

Past evidence is built as had been + -ing.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

had been + -ing + for/since. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended duration before past effect.

E2

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating.

had been + -ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended past evidence effect.

E3

I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed.

had been + -ing + when. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended interrupted process effect.

E4

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed.

had been + -ing + for/since. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended duration before past effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

They had been testing the system for hours before it failed. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses had been + -ing + for/since accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Her hands were covered in paint because she had been decorating. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses had been + -ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

I had been preparing the report when the priorities changed. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses had been + -ing + when accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

07 · FEEDBACK

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

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RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.